Dream *Wedding*
BUILDER

The Courthouse Wedding Kit

License to lunch: every step of a courthouse wedding, on paper.

WHAT IS INSIDE

- License and paperwork checklist, step by step
- Questions to call the clerk
- Witness and ID list
- Courthouse-day timeline and what to bring
- Small reception plan and guest list
- Budget page
- After the wedding: copies and name change

HOW TO USE THIS KIT

Before you start

Work through the pages in order. The first three pages get the license and the appointment settled; the rest plan the day and what comes after.

Marriage license rules are set locally. Fees, waiting periods, how long a license stays valid, witness rules and whether you need an appointment all differ by county and change over time. This kit never states them as fact: it gives you the questions, and your county clerk gives you the answers. Write those answers in this kit so both of you can see them.

Keep one copy of this kit, and write the date beside every answer you get from an office, so you know how current it is.

Personal-use license and limits

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This kit is an organizing aid. It is not legal, financial or professional wedding-planning advice. Rules, fees and requirements differ by place and change over time: confirm every one with the office or vendor responsible before you rely on it.

Questions: info@weddingchecklistpdf.com

STEP-BY-STEP CHECKLIST

License and paperwork, step by step

Tick each step and write the date it was done. Your clerk's office may order these differently; follow what they tell you.

- [ ] Choose where you will marry and find the office that issues the license there (usually the county clerk or recorder). _____
- [ ] Call or check the clerk's official website and answer the questions on the next page. _____
- [ ] Gather the identification and documents the clerk asks for, for both of you. _____
- [ ] If either of you was married before, find the divorce decree or death certificate the clerk may ask to see. _____
- [ ] Apply for the marriage license, together if the office requires both of you. _____
- [ ] Note any waiting period before the license can be used, and the date it expires. _____
- [ ] Book the ceremony: a courthouse appointment, a judge or officiant, or your own officiant if allowed. _____
- [ ] Confirm your witnesses and tell them what ID to bring. _____
- [ ] Hold the ceremony and sign the license with the officiant and witnesses. _____
- [ ] Confirm who returns the signed license to the office, and by when. _____
- [ ] Order certified copies of the marriage certificate. _____

WRITE THE ANSWERS DOWN

Questions to call the clerk

Call the office that issues the license. Ask each question, write the answer, and the date you were told.

Do we apply in person, online, or both? Do we both need to be there?

Which ID and documents does each of us need to bring?

What is the fee, and which payment methods do you accept?

Is there a waiting period after the license is issued? How long is it valid?

Do we need an appointment for the ceremony? How far ahead should we book?

Who can officiate? Can we bring our own officiant?

Do we need witnesses? How many, how old, and what ID do they bring?

How many guests may come into the ceremony room? Are photos allowed?

How do we order certified copies, and what does each cost?

Date of call: _____ Spoke to: _____

WHO SIGNS, AND WHAT THEY BRING

Witnesses and ID

Only list as many witnesses as your clerk requires. Confirm each person has the ID the office asked for.

Name	Role	ID they bring	Phone	Confirmed

Our own documents

Document	Partner 1	Partner 2	Where it is
Photo ID			
Birth certificate (if asked)			
Social Security number (if asked)			
Prior divorce or death certificate			
Marriage license			

TIMELINE

The courthouse day

Build the day backwards from your appointment time. Courthouses often have security lines, so leave a buffer.

Time	What happens	Who	Done
	Leave home		
	Park / arrive, allow for security		
	Check in at the clerk's office		
	Ceremony		
	Sign the license with officiant and witnesses		
	Photos outside		
	Lunch or reception		

PACKING CHECKLIST

What to bring

- [ ] Both photo IDs, and any documents the clerk asked for
- [ ] The marriage license (if issued before the day)
- [ ] Payment for any fees due on the day
- [ ] Rings
- [ ] Your vows, on a card
- [ ] Witnesses (and their ID)
- [ ] Officiant's details, if bringing your own
- [ ] Phone charged, and someone to take photos
- [ ] Flowers or a small bouquet, if you want one
- [ ] Tissues, mints, a pen that works
- [ ] Directions, parking money, and the office's phone number
- [ ] Reservation details for afterwards

PLAN THE CELEBRATION

A small reception

A meal, a picnic or a party at home. Compare two or three options before you book.

Option	Where	Seats	Cost estimate	Book by

Guest list

Name	Invited how	RSVP	Meal / dietary note

BOOKING AND RUNNING ORDER

Reception details

Venue or restaurant, address and contact:

Reservation name, time and deposit:

Menu or catering plan:

Cake or dessert:

Toasts and who gives them:

Time	What happens	Who

ESTIMATED, ACTUAL, PAID

Budget

Fill in the amounts your clerk and vendors quote you. Leave a line blank rather than guess.

Item	Estimate	Actual	Paid
Marriage license			
Ceremony or officiant fee			
Certified copies			
Outfits			
Rings			
Flowers			
Photographer			
Reception / meal			
Cake			
Travel and parking			
Announcements			
Other			
TOTAL			

COPIES AND NAME CHANGE

After the wedding

Each agency sets its own rules for updating a name. Check its official website for current steps before you go.

- [ ] Signed license returned to the office (by whom, by when) _____
- [ ] Certified copies ordered and received _____
- [ ] Social Security record updated (if changing a name) _____
- [ ] Driver's license or state ID updated _____
- [ ] Passport updated _____
- [ ] Bank accounts and cards _____
- [ ] Employer and payroll _____
- [ ] Insurance and benefits _____
- [ ] Voter registration _____
- [ ] Utilities, leases and subscriptions _____

TRACKER

Announcements and thank-yous

Name	Told how	Gift	Thank-you sent